PROJECT BUDDY
Built by a tradesman, for tradesmen.

Before You Sign

A homeowner's quote checklist

Read the contractor's quote with a pen in your hand. Tick a box only if the quote is clear on that point — **in writing**. Every box left empty is a question to ask before you sign, and the answer belongs on the quote, not in a promise.

- ☐ **The allowance matches the product.** Any allowance (tile, flooring, fixtures) is priced at or above the product you were shown or picked — not quietly below it.
- ☐ **Products are named.** Fixtures and materials are listed by brand and model, so what gets installed is what you actually agreed to.
- ☐ **Work the job needs is in the quote.** Nothing the job plainly needs is left out — waterproofing under tile, disposal, patching, permits. What's not in the quote becomes an extra later.
- ☐ **No open “to be decided” lines.** Anything marked TBD or “to be confirmed” carries a top price written beside it.
- ☐ **Hidden damage has a rate.** If subfloor, rot or framing repairs turn up, the quote already says what that work costs — before anybody finds it.
- ☐ **Permits are covered.** The quote says whether permits are included, and if they are not, who gets them and who pays for them.
- ☐ **Payments match the work.** The deposit and the payment schedule never run ahead of the work actually finished. Big money up front is a warning sign.
- ☐ **Change orders have rules.** Extra work has a stated rate, and nothing extra starts until you have signed off on it in writing.
- ☐ **Dates are in writing.** A start date and a finish date are on the quote — not “some time next month.”
- ☐ **The warranty is written down.** What is covered, and for how long, is on paper — not just said out loud.

Want the full teardown?

Project Buddy's **Quote Check** takes a contractor's quote apart line by line and prices it against fair market — the fair lines, the padded lines and the hooks, all in a written report. **$99 a report.** Find it on the Estimating page of our website.